

4.5.2 Internet Explorer 7

The latest version of the most-widely used Web browser was first made available under Windows XP. The browser brings several changes and feature additions—long overdue—to the table. The most important point of difference between the IE7 implementation under XP and Vista is that for Vista, IE7 is not integrated into the operating system, as Internet Explorer was for previous versions of Windows. IE7 under Vista runs in a protected mode, wherein it is separated from the rest of the system; exploits and malicious content are prevented from writing to any other part of the system (except the Temporary Internet Files) without explicit user consent. IE7 can also be launched without any add-ons or ActiveX controls—all third-party toolbars are also disabled in this mode.

Apart from these security measures, IE7 introduces an RSS feed discovery icon and a feed reader. The discovery icon is greyed and disabled while browsing a site that doesn't offer content syndication, while it activates to a bright orange if it stumbles upon an RSS feed. The feed reader is quite capa-



Tabs and RSS feeds in IE7

ble—offering a standard newspaper layout, alongside a search utility and some filtering options based on date, author, and title.

Interestingly, any feeds added through Internet Explorer 7 are added to a Common Feed List—an OS-wide repository for RSS feeds. Thus a feed can be visible under more than one supported program. For example, feeds added through IE7 are automatically made visible in the RSS feeds Gadget found in the Windows Sidebar; unfortunately, this is the only means of adding an RSS feed to the Sidebar Gadget for now.